

AI LITERACY

Helpful or hollowing

The same tool, in the same subject, with opposite results. The difference is which part it does.

The rule of thumb

If the tool does the part that would have built the skill, the skill does not get built. Everything else is fair game.



Helps vs hollows

Helps

Explaining a step you are stuck on, generating extra practice, checking your reasoning.

Hollows

Writing the paragraph, solving the problem, choosing the argument.



THE POINT

Struggle is where the understanding comes from

Wrestling with a problem before being shown the method improves understanding and transfer, at an effect size of 0.36.



Three questions before you paste a prompt

1. What would I have learned doing this myself?
2. Can I check the answer?
3. Would I be fine if it were wrong?



Where it is reliable and where it is not

**Summarise a document
you supply**

2 to 5% error

**Short factual recall with
no tools**

Around 40%

Reliability depends on the task.



The sycophancy trap

A student who pushes back because they assume they are wrong tends to get agreement. Correct answers get abandoned 14.66% of the time under pushback.



THE TAKEAWAY

Do the thinking, then bring in the tool

The order is the whole lesson. Ask for the effort back before you ask for the answer.

